BURNOUT THEORY · WINDOWS VST3 · ACID BASS SYNTHESIZER

COMPLETE USER MANUAL

ACID303 SOLO V3.0.0

All v2.0.6 sound and editing functions + V3 pattern banks, transpose and FL Studio MIDI arrangement.

1A / 1B	2A / 2B	3A / 3B	4A / 4B
2 x 8 patterns	2 x 8 patterns	2 x 8 patterns	2 x 8 patterns
01 - 16	**17 - 32**	**33 - 48**	**49 - 64**

64	154	16	36–99
Patterns / preset	Factory presets	Steps / pattern	MIDI trigger notes

> SAVE AFTER EDITING – IMPORTANT
> Editing a step, changing accents/slides, using RANDOM 16, importing MIDI or changing transpose updates the working state. Click SAVE PRESET to keep these changes in the .acid303preset file. Saving the FL Studio project does not overwrite the preset file.

Version: October 27, 2026 · https://github.com/burnouttheory/Acid303-Solo

Contents

This manual brings together the complete base controls from V2 and the new V3 workflows. Each section can be read independently.

1. Introduction and installation
2. Interface, language, skins and preset browser
3. Oscillator, filter, envelope and volume
4. Effects: compressor and distortion
5. Effects: delay and reverb
6. 16-step sequencer and randomisation
7. Piano roll, sequencer modes and MIDI controllers
8. MIDI file import/export and automation
9. Preset management and essential saving rule
10. V3: 64 pattern slots
11. FL Studio pattern triggering step by step
12. Complete MIDI mapping (36–99)
13. Global transpose and arranging examples
14. Sound-design recipes, common issues and compatibility
15. V3 feature descriptions and quick reference

> IMPORTANT DISTINCTION
> MIDI 36–99 select a pattern; the note does not change the bass pitch. TRANSPOSE changes the pitch of the internal sequences.

1. Introduction and installation

Acid303 Solo is a monophonic acid-bass VST3 inspired by classic 303 workflows. This V3 edition keeps the oscillator, filter, envelope, FX and sequencer from v2.0.6 and adds 64 patterns per preset, MIDI pattern selection and global transpose.

Supported setup

Item	Details
Platform	Windows 64-bit / VST3
Host / DAW	FL Studio (tested on the developer's installation)
Audio / MIDI	Via FL Studio mixer and channel piano roll
Presets	*.acid303preset
MIDI files	*.mid / *.midi (import), *.mid (export)

Getting started

1. Close FL Studio before installing. Save important .flp projects and personal presets.
2. Run the Windows installer for Acid303 Solo V3. The official V3 upgrades the v2.0.6 plugin rather than installing a separate instrument.
3. Launch FL Studio and rescan VST3 plugins if needed; insert Acid303 Solo into the Channel Rack.
4. Select the correct Mixer track and ensure the channel is not muted.
5. Load an included factory preset using LOAD PRESET, or use the PRESET arrows.
6. To hear the 16-step sequences, set MODE to SEQUENCER; set MIDI BANKS ON for V3 pattern selection.
7. Open the channel piano roll and add sustained MIDI trigger notes. Press FL Studio Play.

> TIP
> PIANO ROLL mode plays individual pitched notes from the DAW. SEQUENCER mode plays Acid303's programmed step sequences.

2. Interface, language, skins and presets

The top bar groups loading/saving, patch name, language, skins, tempo and update checking. All controls remain part of one plugin window.

Control	Purpose
< / >	Browse presets in the current/last selected folder and its subfolders.
PRESET	Shows the name of the active patch.
SAVE PRESET / SAUVER PRESET	Opens a Windows Save As dialog; saves patch data and all 64 patterns.
LOAD PRESET / CHARGER PRESET	Opens a .acid303preset using the Windows file picker.
FOLDER / DOSSIER	Opens the preset directory in Windows Explorer.
FRANÇAIS / ENGLISH	Changes the plugin interface language.
SKINS / THÈMES	Switches the plugin visual style; does not change its sound.
BPM	Displays the host tempo (or a fallback if unavailable).
UPDATE / MISE À JOUR	Checks a published update and opens its download page.

About skins

Factory themes are provided with the plugin. TB303 GREY V3 has a brushed-metal style with softer neon-green text/accents. Skins are visual only; user theme files use the .acid303skin extension.

> WHERE TO FIND PRESETS
> Use the FOLDER / MIDI FOLDER buttons instead of guessing Windows paths. Typical personal path: Documents\Acid303\presets; MIDI: Documents\Acid303\midi; skins: Documents\Acid303\skins.

3. Oscillator, filter, envelope and volume

The original V2 sound controls remain central in V3. These shape tone independently of which of the 64 patterns is currently active.

Section	Control	What it changes
OSCILLATOR	WAVE	Blend between saw-like and pulse-like oscillation.
	SHAPE	Pulse width / timbre shaping.
	TUNE	Fine pitch adjustment (−12 to +12 semitones).
FILTER	CUTOFF	How much high-frequency content passes the filter; logarithmic response.
	RESO	Resonance and familiar acid emphasis around cutoff.
	MOD	Amount of low-frequency filter modulation.
	LFO RATE	Speed of that modulation.
ENVELOPE	ENV MOD	Depth of the envelope-driven filter sweep.
	DECAY	How quickly a note/envelope dies away.
	SLIDE TIME	Transition time of legato slides.
	ACCENT	Strength of accent response.
OUTPUT	MASTER VOL	Final output after processing; adjust to avoid clipping.

A simple acid tone

1. Start with low CUTOFF, medium-to-high RESO and a moderate ENV MOD.
2. Play a 16-step pattern containing alternating notes and silences.
3. Increase ACCENT, add SLIDE on selected transitions, then listen to the filter movement.
4. Gradually open CUTOFF; adjust MASTER VOL to keep the Mixer level controlled.

> TUNE VS TRANSPOSE
> TUNE is the oscillator sound/pitch control inherited from V2. V3 TRANSPOSE is a dedicated global offset for the internal pattern notes. MIDI trigger-note numbers stay fixed.

4. Effects: compressor and distortion

Each module has an ON/OFF switch. Use DRY/WET to blend processed sound with the original signal. For sound-design changes, save the preset afterwards.

3-band compressor

Parameter	Role
LOW	Low-band treatment / emphasis
MID	Midrange response
HIGH	High-frequency response
GAIN	Post-processing output gain (not a substitute for mastering headroom)
DRY/WET	Processed/original signal blend

Distortion

The validated V3 retains the two selection options TUBE and BITCRUSHER, chosen with the left/right arrows. TUBE is the refined acid-drive saturation sound; BITCRUSHER produces digital lo-fi roughness. The same DRIVE, LEVEL, EQ and DRY/WET controls apply.

DRIVE	Saturation intensity
LEVEL	Distortion block output level
EQ	Tone balance
DRY/WET	Effect balance

> WATCH THE OUTPUT
> When raising DRIVE or compression GAIN, lower LEVEL / MASTER VOL when needed to avoid unwanted clipping in FL Studio.

5. Effects: delay and reverb

Both effects can be activated separately with ON/OFF and combined with each other or with the distortion and compressor.

Delay / echo

Control	Function
TIME	Time between repetitions / tempo-related delay timing
FEEDBACK	Amount fed back into the delay; higher values produce more repeats
WIDTH	Stereo width of the delay output
DRY/WET	Echo level relative to the direct signal
NORMAL	Conventional delay
PING-PONG	Left/right alternating stereo echo
SYNC	Shows the tempo-based division in use

Reverb / ambience

SIZE	Perceived ambience/space size
VOLUME	Reverb signal level
DRY/WET	Blend of dry bass and reverb

Recommended starting points

• For a tight rolling bass, keep reverb low and delay subtle. Short delays can add momentum without blurring notes.

• For breakdowns, try PING-PONG with wider stereo and increased DRY/WET; return to subtler levels for the main groove.

> TEMPO SYNC
> Delay timing and sequence speed are connected to the host BPM when FL Studio supplies transport information.

6. The 16-step sequencer and RANDOM 16

Every pattern contains up to 16 steps. Four edit rows control a step’s musical content; the top numbered/LED row sets the active loop length.

Row	Action
1–16 / LOOP	Click a numbered LED to set a 1- to 16-step loop length.
ACCENT	Toggle emphasis on a chosen step.
SLIDE	Toggle the note glide/legato transition on that step.
NOTE	Click to open the pitch menu; mouse wheel raises/lowers by semitone.
ON / OFF	Enable or mute individual steps.
RATE / VITESSE	Choose 1/4, 1/8, 1/16 or 1/32 per sequencer step.

Edit a pattern

1. Select the pattern you intend to modify.
2. Click NOTE on steps 1, 3, 5 and 7; choose the desired notes.
3. Activate ON/OFF only on the intended steps; add an ACCENT on step 1.
4. Try a SLIDE on step 5 and set loop length to 8 by clicking LED 8.
5. Play the sequence and choose RATE 1/16 or 1/8 to compare results.
6. Click SAVE PRESET to write the changes to disk.

RANDOM 16 / ALÉATOIRE 16

RANDOM 16 generates a new 16-step phrase with notes, rests, accents and slides, without intentionally changing the synth sound/effects. It replaces the selected pattern’s working sequence. There is no automatic save to the preset file.

> DO NOT LOSE YOUR RANDOM PATTERN
> If the result is useful, select SAVE PRESET immediately and give it a personal file name. Switching files or reloading the Factory preset can discard the unsaved pattern.

7. MIDI play modes and controller setup

The two MIDI play modes originate in V2. V3 adds an optional MIDI BANKS switch to SEQUENCER mode.

Mode	Result
PIANO ROLL	Each note in FL Studio sounds at its own pitch; pattern banks are not selected.
SEQUENCER + BANKS OFF	A held note starts/stops the manually selected sequence (legacy V2 behavior).
SEQUENCER + BANKS ON	Held notes MIDI 36–99 select and loop patterns 1A–1 through 4B–8.

Use a MIDI keyboard in PIANO ROLL mode

1. Insert Acid303 Solo and leave MODE: PIANO ROLL.
2. Connect/enable the MIDI keyboard in FL Studio settings.
3. Play notes; their pitch corresponds to the keyboard/piano-roll notes.
4. Adjust TUNE/filter/envelope as desired; save the patch if those settings should be reusable.

CONFIG MIDI / MIDI SETUP and automation

1. Click MIDI SETUP to display the FL Studio controller-linking instructions.
2. In FL Studio, move or right-click a plugin parameter/control and select the host’s “Link to controller” function as appropriate.
3. Move the desired physical knob or fader on your USB/MIDI controller.
4. Confirm the mapping, then test the knob while the project is playing.
5. For automation, create an FL Studio automation clip for the intended plugin parameter and draw a time curve.

> CONTROL ASSIGNMENT
> MIDI SETUP provides guidance for FL Studio’s native controller-linking workflow; it is not a separate MIDI-learn engine that must be configured outside FL Studio.

8. MIDI import/export and automation

The plugin can export a selected sequence to a standard .mid file and import a MIDI phrase back into the selected slot.

Button	What it does
EXPORT MIDI	Exports the current pattern, including tempo rate and up to 16 steps.
IMPORT MIDI	Imports MIDI into the current pattern, overwriting its step content.
MIDI FOLDER / DOSSIER MIDI	Opens the default MIDI folder.

Export a phrase

1. Select the correct pattern group and number.
2. Set the desired GLOBAL TRANSPOSE: exported sounding notes include this offset.
3. Click EXPORT MIDI and choose a .mid file name/location.
4. Import that .mid into another FL Studio instrument or sequencer to hear the written pitches.

Import a phrase

1. Select the destination pattern; optionally save the current preset first.
2. Click IMPORT MIDI and select a .mid or .midi file (maximum 8 MB).
3. Verify NOTE, ON/OFF, ACCENT and SLIDE in the resulting 16-step grid.
4. Click SAVE PRESET to retain the imported data.

> MIDI FILE LIMITATION
> An external MIDI file may not preserve every Acid303-specific accent/slide/step flag. Native exported metadata can carry more information. Importing changes only the selected pattern.

9. Presets: how to save correctly

> SAVE PRESET IS ESSENTIAL
> Any change in a loaded preset (including RANDOM 16, note changes, slides, accents, FX, transpose, MIDI import) must be saved to a .acid303preset file if you wish to reuse it later. Otherwise reloading the preset restores the previous saved data.

1. Load a Factory preset with LOAD PRESET.
2. Change a note in 1A–1, then switch to another bank and press RANDOM 16.
3. Adjust CUTOFF and (if needed) TRANSPOSE. The working state now differs from the stored file.
4. Click SAVE PRESET. Choose a personal directory and a new file name, rather than overwriting the Factory source.
5. Confirm the Save As dialog, then reload your new file to verify both modified banks and transpose.
6. When saving a FL Studio project, save its .flp separately. This stores the project state but does not overwrite the reusable preset on disk.

Save type	Keeps	Does NOT
FL Studio .flp	Plugin state within that project	Replace the source .acid303preset
.acid303preset	Patch + 64 patterns + transpose, reusable in other projects	Automatically save the FL Studio song

Factory and User files

V3 ships with 154 expanded Factory presets, each containing 64 distinct musical sequences; older v2.0.6 files remain readable but may have only the original pattern in 1A–1. Your personal presets are not meant to be overwritten during an upgrade.

10. V3: 64 independent patterns

A V3 preset now contains 8 pattern groups × 8 slots = 64 individual melodic sequences, each retaining its own 16-step content and loop length.

1A / 1B	2A / 2B	3A / 3B	4A / 4B
2 x 8 patterns	2 x 8 patterns	2 x 8 patterns	2 x 8 patterns
01 - 16	**17 - 32**	**33 - 48**	**49 - 64**

UI control	Function
GROUP / SECTION	Select group 1A, 1B, 2A, 2B, 3A, 3B, 4A, 4B
PATTERN 1–8	Select one of eight patterns in that group
MIDI BANKS ON/OFF	Enables MIDI 36–99 pattern selection in Sequencer mode
MIDI MAP 64 / CARTE MIDI 64	Shows 64 numbers, offers copy-to-clipboard and slot selection
TRANSPOSE / TRANSPOSITION	Non-destructive semitone offset applied to all banks

Pattern selection does not rewrite the sequence

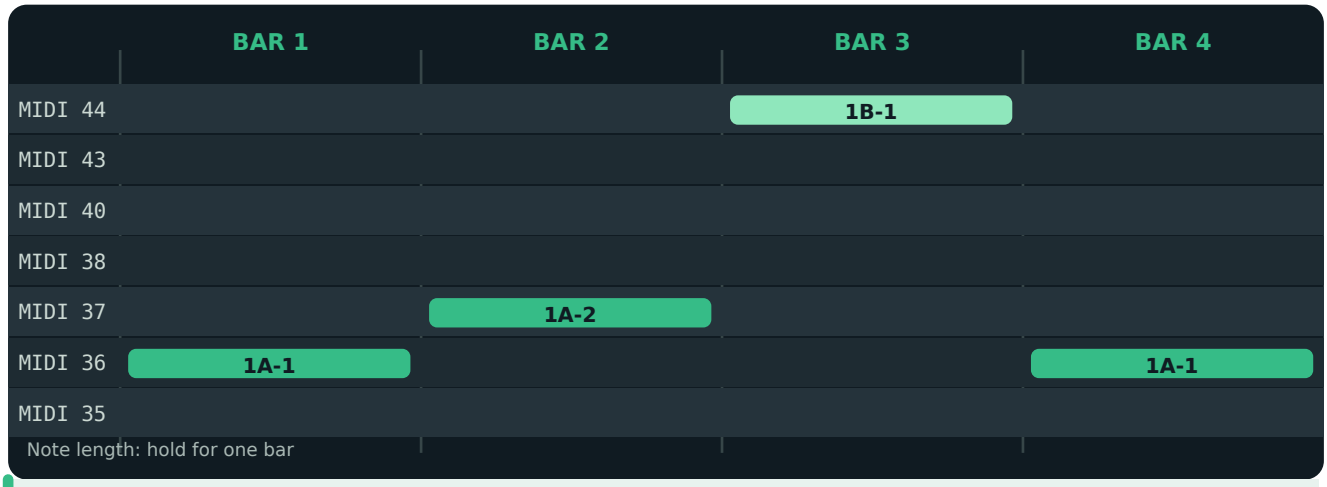
Changing GROUP/PATTERN moves the edit focus to another pattern. RANDOM 16 and 16-step grid edits apply to the selected pattern only. SAVE PRESET stores all 64 patterns at once.

> LEGACY PRESETS
> Older V2 presets can load into V3, but to have populated material in every slot, use the expanded V3 Factory presets.

11. FL Studio: switch patterns using the piano roll

These are trigger notes, not the pitches of the synthesized bass. A single held note selects and repeats one complete pattern.

1. Insert Acid303 Solo VST3 in FL Studio; load a V3 Factory preset using LOAD PRESET.
2. Set MODE: SEQUENCER (not PIANO ROLL).
3. In PATTERN BANK, click MIDI BANKS until it displays ON.
4. Click MIDI MAP 64 and note these examples: 1A–1 = MIDI 36; 1A–2 = 37; 1B–1 = 44; 4B–8 = 99.
5. In the FL Studio Channel Rack, right-click the Acid303 Solo channel and choose Piano roll.
6. In the vertical keyboard on the left, locate MIDI 36 (C; octave number may differ depending on FL Studio settings).
7. Draw a MIDI 36 note at bar 1 and hold it for one bar. Draw MIDI 37 at bar 2, MIDI 44 at bar 3 and MIDI 36 at bar 4.
8. Start playback. The plugin’s GROUP/PATTERN displays follow the selected notes; the internal sequence loops while the note is held.
9. For clean transitions, avoid overlapping trigger notes unless intentionally testing overlapping selection behavior.



OCTAVE NAMING
FL Studio can label the MIDI 36 C note as C3 or another C octave depending on its configuration. The numeric MIDI note is the stable reference.

12. Complete MIDI-to-pattern table

Every group contains eight successive MIDI notes. Formula: MIDI number = 36 + 8 × group index + (pattern number − 1), where group indices 1A, 1B, 2A, 2B, 3A, 3B, 4A, 4B are numbered 0 to 7.

Groupe / Group	P1	P2	P3	P4	P5	P6	P7	P8
1A	36 C	37 C#	38 D	39 D#	40 E	41 F	42 F#	43 G
1B	44 G#	45 A	46 A#	47 B	48 C	49 C#	50 D	51 D#
2A	52 E	53 F	54 F#	55 G	56 G#	57 A	58 A#	59 B
2B	60 C	61 C#	62 D	63 D#	64 E	65 F	66 F#	67 G
3A	68 G#	69 A	70 A#	71 B	72 C	73 C#	74 D	75 D#
3B	76 E	77 F	78 F#	79 G	80 G#	81 A	82 A#	83 B
4A	84 C	85 C#	86 D	87 D#	88 E	89 F	90 F#	91 G
4B	92 G#	93 A	94 A#	95 B	96 C	97 C#	98 D	99 D#

Each cell lists the numeric MIDI note; chromatic pitch letters are provided as a reference. The MIDI MAP 64 command can also copy the mapping directly to your clipboard.

A few examples

1A–1	MIDI 36	C
1A–8	MIDI 43	G
1B–1	MIDI 44	G#
2A–1	MIDI 52	E
2B–4	MIDI 63	D#
4B–8	MIDI 99	D#

MIDI NOTES ARE TRIGGERS
MIDI 52 selects 2A–1. It does not force the pattern to play in E; use the transpose control if the bass line must change key.

13. Transpose all patterns and build a song

V3 TRANSPOSE offsets the played pitches of all 64 patterns by an integer number of semitones between −12 and +12, without rewriting their original steps. Slides, accents and step gates stay intact.

Setting	Result for C
−12	C one octave lower
0	Unchanged C
+2	D / ré
+5	F / fa
+7	G / sol
+12	C one octave higher

Example: match a Serum bass in F

1. Load the desired Acid303 Solo preset; check a pattern originally written around C.
2. In Serum or another instrument, play your bass line in F.
3. Set Acid303 Solo TRANSPOSE to +5 semitones. All internal patterns sound five semitones higher.
4. Keep piano-roll trigger notes 36, 37, 44, etc. unchanged; they still select exactly the same banks.
5. Verify the blend and musical key by ear; a simple transpose does not automatically convert major/minor modes.
6. Save the preset to keep TRANSPOSE +5 in the reusable .acid303preset file. Save the .flp project separately.

Song arrangement suggestion

Intro	1A–1	MIDI 36
Main groove	1A–2	MIDI 37
Response	2B–4	MIDI 63
Transition	4B–8	MIDI 99
Return	1A–1	MIDI 36

EXPORT AND TRANSPOSE
Export MIDI includes the sounding transpose offset. Reimporting that export while TRANSPOSE is still active may give an additional transposition when played; check your values.

14. Practical patches, troubleshooting and compatibility

Useful sound-design combinations

Result	Suggested controls
Classic squelch	Raise RESO, modulate CUTOFF with ENV MOD, add accents and short slides.
Rough warehouse sound	TUBE distortion ON; increase DRIVE cautiously; lower LEVEL as needed.
Retro lo-fi	BITCRUSHER, moderate DRIVE, softer filter and low DRY/WET.
Wide break	PING-PONG delay plus light reverb; return to drier sound for the main bass groove.

Common issues

Symptom	First check
Silence / no sound	Mixer routing, active ON/OFF steps, transport, held note, master volume.
Notes play pitches, not banks	Set MODE: SEQUENCER and MIDI BANKS: ON.
Pattern never changes	Check numeric MIDI note 36–99 and that the piano roll targets the correct channel.
Wrong key	Set TRANSPOSE instead of moving the bank-trigger note.
Random edits gone	Reloading Factory discards uncommitted work: use SAVE PRESET.
Old presets with empty banks	Choose a V3 expanded Factory preset, or fill/save missing banks manually.
Preset arrows do nothing	Open a folder containing .acid303preset files first.
Updated VST not visible	Close/reopen FL Studio and rescan VST3; check duplicated scanned folders.

Compatibility with earlier projects

The official V3 migration uses the VST3 identity of v2.0.6 to upgrade the existing instrument instead of coexisting as a second plugin. Compatibility was tested by the developer using existing FL Studio projects. Keep project and preset backups before major updates. V3 TEST builds with a separate VST3 ID may need separate handling.

15. V3 additions and quick reference

This final page summarises what was retained from V2 and what changes in V3.

Capability	V2.0.6	V3.0.0
Oscillator, filter, envelope	✓	✓
4 effect modules	✓	✓
16-step editor	✓	✓
Random, import/export MIDI	✓	✓
Preset/skin/language management	✓	✓
64 patterns in one preset	—	✓
Piano-roll MIDI bank triggers	—	✓
Complete MIDI map	—	✓
Global non-destructive transpose	—	✓
154 expanded factory presets	—	✓
TB303 GREY neon-green metal skin	—	✓

30-second workflow

1. Load a V3 factory preset.
2. Set MODE: SEQUENCER; MIDI BANKS: ON.
3. Place trigger notes 36, 37, 44… in the Acid303 Solo piano roll.
4. Use TRANSPOSE to match another track’s key.
5. Edit steps / effects if needed, then SAVE PRESET.
6. Save the FL Studio project separately.

> OFFICIAL SUPPORT AND DOWNLOADS
> https://github.com/burnouttheory/Acid303-Solo
> Use only official Releases and keep a backup of your custom preset library.

Editorial note: The original V2 PDF was not available in the accessible archive. The V2 chapters in this complete guide were reconstructed from the v2.0.6 source code and technical documentation, and checked against the validated V3 sources.